

01 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Run a hackathon without installing anything

An editable playbook for facilitators, sponsors and business teams.

No code. No agent installation. No Copilot subscription needed to use these materials manually.

Start in five minutes

- Save a working copy in a location approved for your team and the information you will enter. Do not edit the public GitHub copy with customer details.
- Use this Word file as your notebook. Replace bracketed prompts with your own answers; duplicate the use-case, test and handoff pages for each team.
- Use the PowerPoint deck to lead a discussion. Its speaker notes contain prompts and suggested activities. PDF copies are available for reading or printing.
- Ask a sponsor, a knowledgeable process owner and an IT contact to help with decisions you cannot make alone.

Choose your route

Material	What to do with it
Word playbook	Complete the templates, record decisions and keep the evidence together.
PowerPoint workshop	Present or edit the slides; use the speaker notes to guide the group.
PDF copies	Read, share within the permitted audience or print. Use Word/PPT for editing.

How to use the workbook

Pages 2-5: agree scope and choose cases. Pages 6-7: prepare safely. Pages 8-10: run and test the event. Pages 11-12: close and follow up. Pages 13-14: example, reusable prompts and references.

Unknown is not approved. A good score, convincing demo or AI answer never replaces a real permission or a named decision owner.

Public materials v0.1.2 | 12 September 2026 | Project-authored guidance, not an official Microsoft product, corporate policy or hackathon registration.

[Download the latest materials and optional agent](#)

02 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Agree the charter

Complete once with the sponsor before choosing tools or inviting teams.

Complete this	Your working answer
Event and dates	[Name, start/end dates, time zone, location or meeting link]
Sponsor and facilitator	[Who decides? Who runs the event? Name a backup.]
Business outcome	[What should be different for which users? Why now?]
Evidence of the problem	[Current process, pain point and a permitted source or baseline]
People and availability	[Business owners, builders, mentors, judges and support contacts]
Scope and exclusions	[What will be demonstrated? What will not be built or deployed?]
Success and decision rule	[Observable result, judging criteria and who accepts the outcome]
Access and inclusion	[Accessibility needs, breaks, remote participation, language and time zone]
Budget and safety	[Approved spend/capacity, data boundaries, review contacts and stop authority]
Sponsor decision	[Agreed / changes needed / unknown; approver, date and evidence reference]

Keep the roles simple

Sponsor: makes scope and continuation decisions. Facilitator: keeps the plan and decision log. Process owner: knows the real work and checks usefulness. Technical lead/admin: confirms access and safe environments. Data/risk contacts: approve permitted use and human review. Judges: assess demonstrated evidence.

Aim for a prototype that teaches you something useful, not a production rollout. Confirm invitations and data permissions separately.

Source basis: Organize hackathons; Solution envisioning. Timing and role allocation here are project defaults.

03 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Describe one use case

Duplicate this page per candidate. Write in business language first.

Complete this	Your working answer
Case ID, title and priority	[Unique reference, short name and customer-stated priority; record votes separately]
Problem and intended user	[Who does what today? What is slow, costly, risky or frustrating?]
Business / process owner	[Named accountable person; attendance confirmed by whom and when?]
Smallest useful path	[One input -> one action -> one reviewable output]
Sample and permission	[Synthetic/anonymized sample, source, approval owner, date and evidence]
Success test	[Observable pass/fail test, expected result and reviewer]
Baseline and target	[Metric, unit, baseline, target, sample size and measurement period; unknown if missing]
Human review / read-only	[What may it do? Who reviews before any consequential action?]
Alternatives	[Could a simpler process, existing feature or approved SaaS solve this?]
Dependencies and fallback	[Access, connectors, skills, time; permitted mock/test-only route if blocked]
Out of scope	[Production integrations, automatic decisions and features deferred to a later phase]

If the description contains three different solutions, select one slice before assessing it. A mention of images alone is not a reason to choose a vision system.

A demo is a small, reviewable proof. A pilot is a controlled trial with real users, permissions, measurement and an accountable owner.

04 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Check qualification before ranking

Record Pass, Not met or Unknown for each condition, with evidence and a reviewer.

Condition	What to verify
Someone owns the business outcome	A named person accepts the business outcome.
A knowledgeable process owner will attend	The knowledgeable owner explicitly confirmed attendance.
Usable sample / anonymized / synthetic data exists	A usable sample is available and its use is approved.
Consequential actions stay behind human review	Human approval is defined before consequential actions, or the scope is explicitly read-only.
A smallest useful path is defined and demoable during the event	The chosen slice can realistically be shown in the event window.
Does not need several production integrations before anything can be shown	A useful path is possible without several production integrations.
Access / DLP / identity / connector approval can be resolved or mocked	Access and policy requirements are confirmed or have an approved mock route.
Target is a hackathon MVP, not a production rollout	The objective is a prototype, not production deployment.

One record per condition - duplicate eight times

Complete this	Your working answer
Case / condition / status	[Case ID, condition name, Pass / Not met / Unknown]
Evidence / reviewer / date	[Permitted evidence reference, reviewer and review date]
Scope / follow-up	[Scope/version reviewed; missing evidence, action owner and due date]

After all eight records, capture the case decision: [Select / defer / re-scope / reject; reason, decision owner and date].

Do not select a case on score alone when a condition is unmet or unknown. Resolve it, use an explicitly approved narrower scope, or defer.

The first four conditions need explicit factual confirmation; the remaining four also require human judgment about scope and feasibility. These eight conditions are local project controls, not an official corporate standard.

05 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Prioritize with evidence

Optional manual rubric. Do not turn missing evidence into a confident number.

Dimension	Weight	Discuss
Business value	40%	Benefit for the intended users; time, cost, risk or experience.
Feasibility	30%	Skills, time, access and a useful demo path.
Data readiness	20%	Availability, quality, permissions and approved use.
Reusability	10%	Usefulness to additional teams after appropriate review.

Use 1-5 only when a reviewer can explain the evidence. For a local workshop, agree anchors before scoring: 1 = weak evidence/fit, 3 = credible bounded potential, 5 = strong evidence/fit. These anchors and weights are project defaults. Leave unknown dimensions unscored and resolve them before comparing totals.

Weighted score = value x 0.40 + feasibility x 0.30 + data readiness x 0.20 + reuse x 0.10.

Worked arithmetic only: 4, 3, 3, 4 gives $1.6 + 0.9 + 0.6 + 0.4 = 3.5 / 5$. Local bands: High ≥ 4.0 ; Medium ≥ 3.0 and < 4.0 ; Low < 3.0 . This example is not an evaluation of a real use case.

Choose the simplest viable solution

- First consider a process change or no-agent solution, then an existing approved feature or SaaS product.
- Discuss Copilot Studio with a technical lead when a guided conversation, supported knowledge or workflow is central.
- Discuss Azure specialist services only when there is an evidenced need for custom processing, models or infrastructure.
- If both are needed, keep the prototype bounded and record the remaining integration work. If evidence is absent, leave the platform undecided.

Complete this	Your working answer
Scores and rationale	[Each score, supporting evidence, reviewer and date]
Customer priority / votes	[Preserve source values; these are not the assessment score.]
Decision / override	[Reason, owner, date and what evidence changed]

The companion app's mock scores are demonstration fixtures, not reliable real-world recommendations. This manual workbook does not need the app or any AI model.

06 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Prepare the event: people and access

Start checks 1-7 of 13. Use these questions with your sponsor and IT contact.

Duplicate the evidence record for each check. Record status, owner, due date and evidence in your working copy. Use Pass / Not met / Unknown. The suggested timing is adjustable; it is not a Microsoft requirement.

Check / suggested timing	Evidence to request
1. Sponsor, outcome and decision criteria agreed (28 days before)	Sponsor, outcome, judging and acceptance criteria agreed; retain the charter decision.
2. Registration, accessibility and collaboration ready (21 days before)	Attendance, accessibility, location/meeting, time zone, Wi-Fi and support confirmed.
3. No-agent and prebuilt alternatives considered (21 days before)	Record the simpler/no-agent/prebuilt alternatives before a custom build.
4. Small portfolio and one demo path per team selected (14 days before)	Select a small portfolio, one demo path per team, skills and mentor coverage.
5. Baseline, target and measurement owner recorded (14 days before)	Record metric, unit, baseline, target, sample, time period and measurement owner.
6. Licenses, publishing entitlement and capacity confirmed (14 days before)	Admin confirms licenses, capacity and allowed demo channel. Copilot Studio trial is test-chat-only, not publishing.
7. Approved environment and least-privilege access tested (14 days before)	Admin confirms approved environment, region and least-privilege roles; test as a participant.

Reusable evidence record

Complete this	Your working answer
Check, status and owner	[Check number; Pass / Not met / Unknown; accountable person]
Due date and evidence	[Due date; permitted evidence link/reference; approver and approval date]
Scope and next action	[Scope/version approved; remaining action and who follows up]

Keep evidence in the approved team location. An entry in this workbook is not itself an authorization to process data or publish an agent.

07 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Prepare the event: data and dry run

Start checks 8-13 of 13. Close unknowns before the go/no-go decision.

Duplicate the evidence record for each check. Record status, owner, due date and evidence in your working copy. Use Pass / Not met / Unknown. The suggested timing is adjustable; it is not a Microsoft requirement.

Check / suggested timing	Evidence to request
8. Sample data and knowledge permissions verified (7 days before)	Data owner confirms permitted sample use; test access and a denied document as the intended user.
9. DLP, connectors and authentication approved (7 days before)	Admin confirms connector/authentication/data-loss-prevention rules. Never disable policy for the event.
10. Risk assessment and human oversight agreed (7 days before)	Risk contacts confirm intended/forbidden use, human review, escalation and stop authority.
11. Teams distribution or permitted fallback tested (7 days before)	Test the allowed sharing/demo channel. If unavailable, agree test chat or a permitted recording.
12. Team enablement and scoping calls completed (7 days before)	Complete scoping and training; name mentors and access-support contacts.
13. End-to-end dry run and go/no-go recorded (1 day before)	Test sign-in, sample, connectors, useful path and demo channel end-to-end; retain go/no-go decision.

Reusable evidence record

Complete this	Your working answer
Check, status and owner	[Check number; Pass / Not met / Unknown; accountable person]
Due date and evidence	[Due date; permitted evidence link/reference; approver and approval date]
Scope and next action	[Scope/version approved; remaining action and who follows up]

When scope, data, people, channel or permissions change, re-check affected evidence. Do not silently reuse old approval.

08 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Run a two-day event

Sample local-time agenda. Confirm dates, time zone, breaks and accessibility with the group.

Time	Day 1: a useful path	Day 2: evidence and handoff
09:00-09:30	Sponsor opening, outcomes and safety	Checkpoint: what works and what is blocked
09:30-10:00	Tool refresher and team scope	Build the agreed remaining slice
10:00-12:00	Build with a break and mentor check	Test, fix and freeze scope; take a break
12:00-13:00	Lunch / asynchronous catch-up	Lunch / asynchronous catch-up
13:00-14:30	Build and review business usefulness	Prepare demos, evidence and backup recording
14:30-15:30	Mentor checkpoint and blocker decisions	Final demos and judging
15:30-16:30	Confirm working path, fallback and next actions	Exit decisions, owners, dates and retrospective

Facilitator rhythm

- Start with the scope, not the tool. Explain what is out of bounds and who can pause unsafe work.
- Use midday and end-of-day checkpoints. Ask: what useful path works, what is blocked, who owns the decision and what is the fallback?
- Confirm a permitted mock/fallback by the end of Day 1. Mentors guide; the team retains ownership.
- Freeze features before demos. Prepare a backup recording; do not debug live in the showcase.

For three days: keep Day 1 for framing and the first path, use Day 2 for build/checkpoints, and move final testing, demos and decisions to Day 3. Schedule closure after the actual final day.

Suggested post-event rhythm: capture exit packages just after the event, review with the sponsor within a week, confirm follow-on ownership and arrange a 30-day value check. Dates are planning defaults, not commitments.

09 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Keep decisions and blockers visible

Use one team-owned working copy and a named facilitator to reconcile updates.

Blocker record - duplicate as needed

Complete this	Your working answer
Case / time / reporter	[Which team, when, and who raised the issue?]
What is blocked?	[Observable problem and effect on the useful path]
Safety or data concern?	[If yes, stop the affected activity and notify the responsible contact.]
Owner and decision due	[Who can resolve it, and by when?]
Fallback	[Permitted mock, narrower slice, test chat or recording; who approved it?]
Status / resolution	[Open / decision needed / resolved; evidence and date]

Decision record - do not overwrite history

Complete this	Your working answer
Decision / options / reason	[What was chosen and why? Preserve the alternatives.]
Decision owner / date	[Accountable person, decision time and evidence reference]
Impact	[Scope, data, cost, access, timeline and people affected]
Re-checks and communication	[Which approvals/tests must be repeated? Who needs to know?]

If information is missing, keep the status Unknown. Do not convert a blocker into a green status just to keep the agenda on time.

Manual collaboration tip: use an approved shared document, agree the working-copy owner, and append dated decisions. If people edited separate copies, compare changes before merging; never replace another person's work blindly.

10 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Test, then demonstrate

Duplicate the record for each test within each case. Ask the process owner to review it.

Test category	What a reviewer should check
Useful path	The agreed sample produces the expected, reviewable result.
Missing or denied information	The system does not invent evidence or reveal inaccessible content.
Out-of-scope request	It stays within the agreed boundaries and explains the limitation.
Misleading/adversarial input	It does not follow untrusted instructions that conflict with the intended task.
Wrong or unsupported answer	Errors are recorded and corrected; the demo does not hide them.
Consequential action	Human approval is enforced before action, or the read-only boundary is preserved.
Complete this	Your working answer
Test and expected result	[Case/test ID, permitted input and expected behavior]
Observed result	[What happened, Pass / Fail / Not run, reviewer and date]
Evidence and follow-up	[Evidence reference, failure/limitation, fix owner and retest date]

Five-minute readout template

Problem and intended user -> smallest working path -> evidence and tests -> demonstrated result versus estimated benefit -> limitations -> next-step/pilot ask with an owner and date.

A successful demo is not production certification. Say clearly when a path uses a mock, synthetic data or a recording. Never claim measured savings or accuracy without a reviewed measurement set.

Agree judging criteria before the event. Evaluate usefulness, working evidence, safety and learning, not confidence of presentation alone. Only share recordings and screenshots with the approved audience.

11 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Leave with an accountable handoff

Complete one exit package for every case, including Stop / Archive.

Complete this	Your working answer
Case and outcome	[What was actually built? What useful outcome was demonstrated?]
Demo or blocker	[Permitted demo/recording/evidence reference, or the unresolved blocker]
Tests and limitations	[Passed, failed and not-run tests; known gaps and remaining risks]
Exit decision and reason	[Stop/Archive; Customer-led; Partner-led pilot; Microsoft-supported candidate]
Business owner	[Who owns the business result and accepts the next step?]
Technical / delivery owner	[Who owns engineering, operations and delivery? Confirm acceptance.]
Next milestone and date	[Concrete action, accountable owner, calendar date and time zone]
Continuing case: pilot	[Permitted users/cohort, scope, success criteria, budget and risk reviews]
Stop case: cleanup	[Who preserves learnings and closes access/resources, and by when?]
Engagement confirmation	[If support is requested: actual owner, current eligibility, scope and funding; otherwise Pending]

A recommended Microsoft or partner route is not an entitlement or delivery promise. The actual engagement owner must confirm availability, eligibility and responsibility.

Do not deploy the prototype to production as a reward for winning. Production needs a separate readiness, privacy/security, operations and ownership decision.

12 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

Close safely and check value

The event ends; accountability and measurement continue.

Four closure checks

Before marking the event closed	Evidence to retain
Scenario and safety tests	Test results, failures, reviewers and known limitations.
Demo and judging readout	Working evidence, benefit statement, limitations and judging outcome.
Exit ownership	Every case has a decision, business owner and dated next milestone.
Retention and cleanup	Permitted audience, retention/deletion dates, access and resource cleanup owners.

Value measurement record

Complete this	Your working answer
Metric and unit	[Time per task, error rate, adoption or another observable measure]
Baseline and method	[Before value, sample size, time period and method; unknown if absent]
Target / actual	[Keep the hoped-for target separate from measured pilot results.]
Owner / check-in	[Measurement owner and calendar date, typically about 30 days later]
Trade-offs and failures	[Cost, quality, user feedback, risks and limitations alongside benefits]

If reporting a rate, include its numerator, denominator, test conditions and reviewer. Small synthetic demonstrations do not establish an overall accuracy percentage or return on investment.

Plan resource cleanup with the admin and data owner. Preserve required evidence first. This workbook does not delete resources or grant authority to do so.

Complete the retrospective: what helped, what blocked teams, what should change, and what can be safely reused. Share only approved, appropriately labeled artifacts.

13 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

A fictional worked example

Illustration only. These are not customer records, real approvals or measured results.

Canvas element	Fictional example: shipping FAQ helper
Problem	A fictional logistics team repeats the same shipment-policy questions.
Owner	Workshop process-owner role; assign a real consenting owner in your working copy.
Useful path	Ask one policy question -> find a passage in five synthetic FAQs -> draft an answer with its source.
Boundary	Read-only answer draft. No shipment updates, refunds or customer messages.
Alternative	First compare a searchable FAQ and existing approved search features.
Sample / permission	Five invented FAQ pages. Permission and suitability remain Unknown until your data owner confirms the chosen sample.
Test	Answer a covered question with the correct source; say information is missing for an uncovered question.
Access test	Use an approved test environment to verify that a restricted page is not disclosed.
Value	Hypothesis: less time finding guidance. Baseline and actual savings are not measured.
Decision	Re-scope or defer until owner attendance, sample approval and intended access are confirmed.
Next action	Facilitator to assign the process owner and a calendar date for sample/access review.

Optional prompt for an approved AI assistant

Review this fictional use case. Identify missing evidence and the smallest useful demo. Compare a no-agent option before suggesting a platform. Keep unknowns explicit. Do not invent approvals, accuracy or cost savings. Do not contact anyone, publish or provision resources.

Using AI is optional. You can do the same review with a colleague using pages 3-5. Use only information approved for the selected service.

14 / FACILITATOR WORKBOOK

References and reusable questions

Public reference pack reviewed 9 September 2026; materials prepared 12 September 2026.

These materials adapt the published project methodology: runbook/rubric/agendas/sources v1.0.0; qualification/routing/handoff v1.1.0. The schedule, weights, bands and checks are project defaults, not Microsoft corporate policy. Check current public product guidance and your internal rules before acting.

Public Microsoft references

[Organize hackathons](#)

[Envision and uncover high-value Power Platform use cases](#)

[Copilot Studio licensing and subscriptions](#)

[Work with Power Platform environments](#)

[Configure data policies for agents](#)

[Connect and configure an agent for Teams and Microsoft 365 Copilot](#)

[Knowledge sources summary](#)

[Technology plan for AI agents](#)

[Responsible AI policies](#)

[Measure and communicate business value](#)

[Manage AI agents across your organization](#)

[Frontier Accelerate for Azure](#)

Questions that work without any tool

- Before the event: who owns the outcome, what will one useful path prove, and what permission is still missing?
- At a checkpoint: what works now, what is blocked, who decides, and what is the permitted fallback?
- At closure: what was demonstrated, what remains unknown, and who owns the next action on what date?

Glossary: MVP = smallest useful prototype; DLP = data-loss-prevention rules; mock = simulated dependency; gate = condition checked before selection; handoff = accepted ownership and a dated next step.

[Latest files and optional Copilot setup](#)

For public feedback, use synthetic examples only. Do not upload completed workbooks, customer data, internal evidence or raw prompt logs to public GitHub. No Microsoft endorsement, competition acceptance or open-source license is implied.